

4. Audio Clips and Loops (To Taste)

Find yourself a few good loops which you can use as the background for your remix—we've thrown in a list later in this chapter. And what's a good remix without some weird sound effects and random voices? Get some of those, too.

5. Time (Plenty, To Taste)

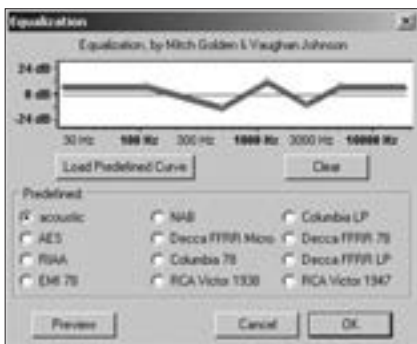
Remixing audio is a task that requires the patience of a hermit—you're not going to get the results you want in a jiffy, so if you expect to churn out a winner in five minutes, you're going to be sorely disappointed.

The Procedure

1. Prepare the track

If you've decided to pick a track from your own collection, your first task is to isolate as much of the voice as possible. To do this, you will need your audio editor's graphic equaliser. You will usually find voice between the 300 Hz and 3 kHz frequencies—use the equaliser to cut out all but this frequency range. Of course, this is going to change from artist to artist, so you will need to experiment with different frequency ranges.

We tried this in Audacity, and its slightly eccentric equaliser, coupled with its lack of a real-time preview, made things rather annoying. Audition,



Audacity's Equaliser—useful, and yet a little useless



Audition's Equaliser—full, functional and fun